

1. Welcome to the Datasette blog

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-13T23:59:39+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/13/welcome-to-the-datasette-blog/#atom-everything>

Welcome to the Datasette blog We have a bunch of neat Datasette announcements in the pipeline so we decided it was time the project grew an official blog. I built this using OpenAI Codex desktop, which turns out to have the Markdown session transcript export feature I've always wanted. Here's the session that built the blog . See also issue 179 . Tags: ai , datasette , generative-ai , llms , ai-assisted-programming , codex

2. Quoting Boris Mann

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-13T16:15:50+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/13/boris-mann/#atom-everything>

?11 AI agents? is meaningless as a phrase. If I said ?I have 11 spreadsheets? or ?I have 11 browser tabs? to do my work, it means about the same thing. ? Boris Mann Tags: ai-agents , ai , agent-definitions

3. CSP Allow-list Experiment

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-13T04:50:45+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/13/csp-allow/#atom-everything>

Tool: CSP Allow-list Experiment An experiment that shows that you can load an app in a CSP-protected sandboxed iframe (see previous note) and have a custom fetch() that intercepts CSP errors and passes them up to the parent window... which can then prompt the user to add that domain to an allow-list and then refresh the page. . Right panel shows Preview with CSP header default-src 'none'; script-src 'unsafe-inline'; style-s... and heading "Sandbox fetch test". A modal dialog from tools.simonwillison.net is overlaid reading: "The sandbox tried to connect to: <https://api.inaturalist.org> Add this origin to the CSP connect-src allow-list and refresh the page?" with an unchecked checkbox "Don't allow tools.simonwillison.net to prompt you again" and Cancel and OK buttons. Below is "Messages from sandbox" showing fetch-catch blocked <https://api.inaturalist.org/v1/observations?per...> connect-src • <https://api.inaturalist.org>. At the bottom left is "Allowed fetch() origins" with an input field containing <https://api.github.com>, an Add button, and a tag <https://api.github.com> x." src="https://static.simonwillison.net/static/2026/csp-allow.jpg" /> I built this one with GPT-5.5 xhigh running...

4. ? Nextpad++

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-13T02:22:16Z

Link: <https://daringfireball.net/2026/05/nextpad>

Nextpad++ feels like a fever dream. Like what Mac apps would be if the Nazis had won WWII.

5. Teresa Ribera Visited the U.S. and No One Noticed

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-12T20:05:28Z

Link: <https://www.politico.eu/article/eu-big-tech-rulebook-shifting-digital-economy-ribera-dma-pulse-forum/>

Jacob Parry and Laura Greenhalgh, reporting for Politico, one month ago: The EU's landmark tech regulations are a ?success story? that are beginning to level the playing field between Silicon Valley's giants and their digital competitors in Europe, said European Competition Commissioner Teresa Ribera on Friday. [...] Ribera's comments come as Brussels prepares for a formal review of the DMA to determine what is working and where the law may need to be reformed. The regulation aims to prevent ?gatekeeper? firms, including Apple, Alphabet and Meta, from using their dominant positions to stifle competition from smaller players. The EU's top antitrust official pushed back against criticism that enforcement has been too slow, arguing that the ?rule of law? requires a methodical approach based on evidence and due process. [...] Ribera

recently returned from a diplomatic mission to Washington and Silicon Valley where she met with U.S. officials and tech executives. She said there is a surprising degree of alignment between European and American priorities, despite the differing political climates. In particular, Ribera highlighted a ?consistent? dialogue with the U.S. Department of Justi...

6. Broadcasters Urge EU to Use the DMA to Go After Smart TV Platforms, None of Which Are From European Companies

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-12T19:34:00Z

Link: <https://www.reuters.com/sustainability/boards-policy-regulation/eu-digital-rules-should-apply-big-techs-smart-tvs-broadcasters-tell-antitrust-2026-03-23/>

Foo Yun Chee, reporting for Reuters back on March 23: Google, Amazon, Apple and Samsung?s smart TVs and virtual assistants should fall under the EU?s toughest tech rules because of their growing market power, the world?s largest broadcasters told EU antitrust chief Teresa Ribera on Monday. The call by the Association of Commercial Television and Video on Demand Services in Europe (ACT) whose members include Canal+, RTL, Mediaset, ITV, Paramount+, NBCUniversal, Walt Disney, Warner Bros Discovery, Sky and TF1 Groupe underscores the battle between ?broadcasters and Big Tech for market share in a lucrative industry. Android TV, which increased its market share from 16% to ?23% from 2019 to 2024, Amazon Fire OS whose market share rose from 5% to 12% in the same period and Samsung?s Tizen OS with its 24% market share should be designated as gatekeepers under the EU?s ?Digital Markets Act, the broadcasters said, citing data from a 2025 market study. Apple is mentioned only in the context of voice assistants, not Apple TV 4K: The broadcasters also voiced concerns about virtual assistants, the most ?well known of which are Amazon?s ?Alexa and Apple?s Siri, while OpenAI entered the field la...

7. AI datacenters in space do not have a cooling problem

Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Wed, 13 May 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://seangoedecke.com/space-ai-datacenters-do-not-have-a-cooling-problem/>

This year Elon Musk has started banging the drum about building AI datacenters in space. As the only person who owns a successful space company and a (moderately) successful AI company, this is a sensible way to boost his profile and net worth. Is it a sensible way to build datacenters? The cooling problem The first comment underneath most discussions of this always goes along these lines: ?you obviously can?t build AI datacenters in space, because heat dissipation is really hard in space, and AI datacenters generate a lot of heat?. In general I am distrustful of snappy answers like these. It reminds me of the ?AI datacenters obviously don?t use a lot of water, because cooling fluid circulates in a closed-loop system? argument: if it were true, there wouldn?t be a debate at all, just one side who understand the obvious point and another side who are stupid. Some arguments are like this! However, more often there?s a complicating factor that makes the snappy answer incorrect. In the water-use case, it?s that the closed-loop system has to itself be cooled by an open-loop evaporative chiller. What about the space datacenter case? Why cooling is possible in space First, let?s give the...

8. The case of the hang when the user changed keyboard layouts

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Wed, 13 May 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260513-00/?p=112318>

Keeping things moving. The post The case of the hang when the user changed keyboard layouts appeared first on The Old New Thing .

9. Software Engineers are Obsolete

Source: iDiallo.com | Published: Wed, 13 May 2026 22:40:00 GMT

Link: <https://idiallo.com/blog/everyone-is-better-than-you?src=feed>

In my first interview for a developer position, I shared a link to my personal project with the interviewer. It was a website for learning how to program. I created it from the ground up. I built the PHP app, designed the database schema, made a nice design to tie it all together. I wrote down my process, and it became the first tutorial on the site. Then I collected tutorials from all over the web and displayed them on my website, which acted as a portal. There was a

section for PHP tutorials, for Ruby on Rails, for .NET, etc. Each one individually curated by me. My interviewer was so impressed. I got the job. Later, I added a section where anyone could submit their own tutorials. It was fascinating how quickly people found my website and started submitting links. The tutorials were coming in so fast that I removed the verification system and let people upload links directly. But then my mind wandered. What if I start a blog? Yes, I had another blog before this one. I built an entire blog engine from scratch. A colleague found my blog. He was so excited that he shared his own with me. At lunch, we would discuss ideas, and that same evening after work, we would buy a domain name a...

10. What's with all the slide decks?

Source: DYNOMIGHT | Published: 2026-05-13T00:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://dynamight.net/slides/>

News from the world of real jobs: Apparently, sometime between 10 and 20 years ago, it became standard for people to communicate by sending slide decks around. These slides are never presented. They aren't intended to be presented. They're born, they're sent around, and they die. What? I stress, the question is not why (or if) people give bad presentations. The mystery is why everyone is using presentation software for communication that is not a presentation. Theory 1: Everybody dumb Is it because we're all dummies? I'm putting this theory first because I suspect that you, beloved readers, will favor it. True, if you ask people why they make slides instead of writing, they'll usually say, "because nobody wants to read". So there's that. But I don't consider this much of an explanation. Dummies though we may be, we've been like that a long time. If we entered the Slideocene 15 years ago, why then? Why not before? Theory 2: The decline of reading Did we get worse at reading? The Discourse seems to have decided this is true, but is it true, or just moral panic? Since 1971, the US has tested 13-year-olds to measure long-term trends in reading ability. This shows a slow improvement u...

11. Stupidly Simple SVG Sparklines

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Wed, 13 May 2026 11:34:01 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/05/stupidly-simple-svg-sparklines/>

A sparkline is a little line-graph with no axes or other unnecessary details. They're useful for getting quick understanding of what the data is showing. They're also really easy to create programmatically. This uses the SVG "polyline" which takes a list of x,y co-ordinate pairs. But can you spot the small problem? <polyline ?

12. Showing Our Work

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-05-13T10:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/05/13/showing-our-work.html>

A preprint went up on arXiv this week from Alexandros Tsakpinis, Emil Schwenger and Alexander Pretschner at fortiss and TU Munich: Modeling Dependency-Propagated Ecosystem Impact of Changes in Maintenance Activities. They built a model of how maintenance changes propagate through the Python dependency graph, ran it over 718,750 PyPI packages and two million dependency edges, and then benchmarked three real-world support mechanisms against it to see how well each one's package selection lined up with where the model says support would do the most good. The three were Tidelf's lifted packages, GitHub Sponsors, and the ecosyste.ms Python fund. The fund is something we run with Open Source Collective: organisations put money in for a language ecosystem as a whole rather than picking individual projects, and we distribute it across the packages our dependency data says are most critical, paying out through whatever funding channel each maintainer already has set up. At 97 packages, that selection accounted for 25.9% of the total modelled improvement impact and 38.0% of the total modelled regression impact across all of PyPI. From the paper: "Ecosyste.ms shows comparatively strong...

13. Pluralistic: Billionaire solipsism, dictator solipsism, AI, and the fascist paradigm (13 May 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Wed, 13 May 2026 15:47:35 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/05/13/vibe-governance/>

Today's links Billionaire solipsism, dictator solipsism, AI, and the fascist paradigm: AGI works best in a K-hole. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Woz's remotes; Furbeowulf; Vinge on AR; Oligarch buys FSU; DNC x GOP megadonors; John Key v Panama Papers; Two elevators, one shaft; Save Firefox! "Cyclopedia Exotica"; Eat the brood. Upcoming appearances: Barcelona, Berlin, Hay-on-Wye, London, NYC, Edinburgh. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. Billionaire solipsism, dictator solipsism, AI, and the fascist paradigm (permalink) With great power comes great solipsism: the more power you wield over other people, the less real they become to you. To rule is to see people as aggregates, statistical artifacts, as a means to an end. It's how people seem when you're at the bottom of a k-hole. Per Granny Weatherwax, this is the root of all evil: "Sin is when you treat people like things":

<https://brer-powerofbabel.blogspot.com/2009/02/granny-weatherwax-on-sin-favorite.html> The problem (for powerful people) is that other people aren't...

14. Open Link in Unloaded Tab, a little Firefox extension

Source: Evan Hahn (dot com) | Published: Wed, 13 May 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://evanhahn.com/open-link-in-unloaded-tab-for-firefox/>

In short: I just published Open Link in Unloaded Tab , a little Firefox extension that adds ?Open Link in Unloaded Tab? to the right-click context menu. In Firefox, you can unload tabs to save system resources. But there?s no way to open a new tab in the unloaded state?until now! I built a very simple extension that adds a new option to do this. (It even has a cute icon which I paid ~\$15 for.) I?ve built one-off extensions before, but this is the first one I?ve submitted to the Firefox Add-ons directory. Download the extension here or check out the source code .

15. Commenting Guidelines

Source: Susam Pal | Published: 2026-05-14T00:00:00Z

Link: <https://susam.net/commenting.html>

Commenting Guidelines This website has an active comments section , carefully maintained and curated by the author of this website. When commenting on this website, please keep the following points in mind: You may include HTML or Markdown in your comment. Comments are converted to HTML and sanitised before they are published on this website. All submitted comments are held for review. Whether a comment is published or not is at the discretion of the author of this website. Typically, only the following types of comments are published: Comments that add new information to the topic discussed in an article. Comments that offer new insight on a topic. Comments that provide a neutral, supporting or opposing viewpoint. Comments that report typos, errors or bugs on the website. Comments that contain good humour. Comments that express appreciation. Generally, rants are not published, even when the post you are commenting on is itself a rant. This website is the author's place to rant. It is not your place to rant. If you really need to rant, please do so on your own website. This guideline exists to maintain a high signal-to-noise ratio in the comments section. Similarly, comments conta...

16. Points are a weird and inconsistent unit of measure

Source: Computer Things | Published: Wed, 13 May 2026 15:56:37 +0000

Link: <https://buttondown.com/hillelwayne/archive/points-are-a-weird-and-inconsistent-unit-of/>

I'm in the middle of redoing the Logic for Programmers diagrams and this has surfaced a really annoying problem. The book is formatted in LaTeX using a pseudo-grid of 10.8pt x7.2pt. The diagrams are done in Inkscape using a 10.8pt x7.2pt. Last week I found out that these are not the same points. Latex defines a point as 1/72.27 inches (0.3515 millimeters). Inkscape instead uses 1/72 inches (0.3528 mm). It's only a difference of 0.4% but it still floors me that two widespread digital technologies would be different! So, uh, what happened? A few hours of reading articles later, this is what I found, caveat that I didn't spend all that much time researching this and this is only initial impressions. what even is a point A point is a

typographic measure, coming from 1517, that is supposedly the smallest interesting size for a printer. This was notably not a standardized measure- different companies in times used different point sizes depending on their equipment. Over time it was standardized, but each country picked a different standard: the German and Japanese point is 0.250 mm, the French point is allegedly 0.399 mm, etc. But early computer history is super Americentric so that's...

17. Ideal failures

Source: Daniel De Laney | Published: Wed, 13 May 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://danieldelaney.net/ideal-failures/>

The way I used to design UI was to sit with paper sketches, or Figma, or a React prototype with no back end. Imagine every failure mode. Design beautiful flows for each. I slipped into this mistake while working on LanWhisper, a voice dictation app. I designed for the failure modes I could imagine, drew the flows, and shipped the app. Then real users hit failure modes that I hadn't anticipated. For example, the AI transcription model can return hallucinated text even if the input audio is empty. I had imagined that if the model returned text at all then the app was working. This failure wasn't in my carefully designed list of ideal failures. Whoops. The problem is that a representation of a system only contains what you put into it. The failure modes it shows you are exclusively the ones you already thought of. This is the same mistake as designing for users you've never talked to. Designers know that's a trap. The same logic applies to the systems we design: imagined systems aren't a substitute for real ones. When designing non-trivial systems, imagination is no longer your best source of truth. The system itself is. And increasingly, designers can build it themselves. Do. Build...

18. Partial static single information form

Source: Max Bernstein's Blog | Published: Tue, 12 May 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: https://bernsteinbear.com/blog/partial-ssi/?utm_source=rss

In compilers, static single information form (SSI) is a common extension to static single assignment form (SSA). It was introduced by C. Scott Ananian in 1999 in his MS thesis (PDF) 1. SSI extends your existing SSA intermediate representation by discovering facts from your existing program and reifying them as path-dependent/flow-sensitive IR nodes. That might sound complicated, but at least the basic idea is pretty natural. I talk a little bit about it in What I talk about when I talk about IRs and I'll rehash here in more depth, starting with some motivating examples. Consider this admittedly contrived example: $v_0 : \text{Integer} = \dots$ if $v_0 > 0$: $\# \dots v_1 : \text{PositiveInteger} = \text{AbsoluteValue } v_0 \# \dots$ We should be able to learn from the comparison that in some branches in the IR, v_0 is positive. In that region, we can add a new IR instruction v_2 that attaches that knowledge right in the instruction's type field (yay, sparseness!) and then rewrite uses of v_0 to now use v_2 . $v_0 : \text{Integer} = \dots$ if $v_0 > 0$: $v_2 : \text{PositiveInteger} = \text{RefineType } v_0, \text{ Positive} \# \dots v_1 : \text{PositiveInteger} = \text{AbsoluteValue } v_2 \# \dots$ Because we've done that, our (imaginary) optimization rule that gets rid of AbsoluteVa...

19. Dutch COVID-19 Data Sources & Their Interpretation

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Sat, 14 Nov 2020 09:04:20 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/dutch-covid-19-data-sources/>

As the world focuses on the terrible (but improving) Dutch COVID-19 numbers, I also see a lot of people interpreting the numbers badly. But we can hardly blame folks since most data is only described in Dutch. And even in Dutch the descriptions can be very confusing. So here goes. NOTE: Corrections and additional links & sources are very welcome on bert@hubertnet.nl or [@berthubert](https://twitter.com/berthubert). The main sources The RIVM is the Dutch CDC?.

20. Some animated Dutch COVID-19 Figures

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Thu, 12 Nov 2020 14:23:24 +0100

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/some-dutch-covid-19-figures/>

Don't take this too seriously. As part of my coping mechanisms, I try to understand the latest (Dutch) COVID-19 figures. I documented where to get the raw data and what they mean in an earlier post. Please note I am not trying to make any kind of point with this data, not

positive, not negative. I have no agenda, please do not read this as me trying to argue things aren't that bad or that they are terrible.

21. End to End Encryption: Talk for the European Internet Forum at the European Parliament

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Mon, 09 Nov 2020 11:03:55 +0100

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/end-to-end-encryption-european-internet-forum/>

Around a million years ago (it feels like) but actually 9 months ago I delivered a brief talk on end to end encryption for the European Internet Forum at the European Parliament. Update: in February 2024, the European Court of Human Rights ruled in rather strong words that forcing providers to break end to end encryption violates human rights. Sorry, your browser doesn't support embedded videos. If you can spare 9 minutes, I recommend watching the video.